

SEXUAL LIBERATION

■ By Damayanti Datta

You grow up being told that you can be anything, do anything. You get a good degree and get yourself into your chosen career. By your mid-20s, you are on a six-figure salary, forging a path in a male-dominated world. You own your own flat, you look great, you feel great, you sleep with men—experimenting physically and emotionally—before finding the right one. You hit 30. By 35—because you can't spare the time now—you'll decide that you want babies. You'll move to your downtown apartment, be a fabulous mother while running a couple of successful businesses. Oh, and you'll write a novel. An autobiography.

23%
of working women
in a 2007 survey
admitted to having
affairs with their
colleagues at work

Whether it happens to you or not, the truth—that you are free to live your life this way—is telling. Sixty years back, your sisters asked for laws and rights to be on equal footing with men. Forty years back, they made tentative forays into the world of work with little help from husbands and a lot of support from mothers, sisters, and mothers-in-law. Your 'new feminist' sisters during the '80s and '90s focused on dowry deaths, rapes and uniform civil codes. In the new millennium, you have assimilated all the battles that liberated you to assert your personal choice.

Statistics show young women are taking charge of sexual choices, including the freedom of delaying

Sex and THE CITY

Changes in public lives have sparked off a transformation in private lives. As economic independence blooms, women assert the right to enjoy their bodies and live the way they want.



COCKTAILS AND CANAPES: Dancing, hookahs and a drink, an evening out with friends